

פרשת תולדות. One of the most famous lines in all of our Torah literature comes from the ברכות of יצחק to יעקב אבינו, which he was able to snatch away from עשו with his mother's help. Right before he gives him the bracha, יצחק says the famous line (27:22) וַיֹּאמֶר הֵקֵל קוֹל יַעֲקֹב וְהִידִים יָדָיו עָשׂוּ. Rashi explains that יצחק meant that יעקב was speaking nicely to him, something that עשו did not usually do. However, יעקב's hands were hairy because of the ridiculous outfit he was wearing.

The מדרש on the phrase קוֹל יַעֲקֹב וְהִידִים יָדָיו עָשׂוּ goes as follows: אין בבתיה ובבתיה מדרשות אין בזמן שהקול קול יעקב נשמע בבתי כנסיות ובבתיה מדרשות אין - ידי עשו שולטין - When we hear the קול of יעקב, then the hands of עשו will not have any power over us. All the מפרשים ask why the מדרש is telling us that? It says וְהִידִים יָדָיו עָשׂוּ, not יָדָיו עָשׂוּ. Even if it's a קול יַעֲקֹב, it's still the יָדָיו עָשׂוּ, the pasuk does not sound like it's one or the other, it sounds like both can be true at the same time. How do we understand what the מדרש is trying to tell us?

The הגר"א, in his inimitable style, [and I always talk about the הגר"א with awe because he deserves it, his genius is incomparable], points out a very interesting fact. The מדרש says, בזמן שהקול קול יעקב נשמע בבתי כנסיות, both of those קול are מלא. When the קול קול יעקב, then ידי עשו, אין הידים ידי עשו.

If you look in the pasuk very carefully, which of course is what we should always do, it says וַיֹּאמֶר הֵקֵל קוֹל יַעֲקֹב. The first קל, is a חסר, it's missing a ו'. That is critical. קל without a ו' is קל. Meaning, when we slack off in our work and efforts, the קול יעקב is getting weaker, it's a חסר, then ידי עשו, ידים ידי עשו. However, if we put in our full כוחות 7/24 in עבודת השם without any kind of slackening, בהם, which is what the מדרש says.

This is a tremendous מוסר השכל. We constantly have to think that there's no time for vacation, there's no time for letting up. We have to keep up our efforts at all times. In that זכות, we will be זוכה to have the עולם and עולם הזה fulfilled and וְהָאֱלֹקִים מְטִיל הַשְּׂמִימָה וּמַשְׁמִינֵי הָאָרֶץ. Besides עולם הזה, we'll get עולם הזה and עולם הבא as מאמע רבקה wanted for us.

